TalentFlow Sprint 3 Progress Update and Retrospective

Completion

Sprint 3 finished the applicant portal and the first version of the AI Engine (4.3), and added user login and sign-up. The careers page (4.2.2) and application form (4.2.3.1) carried over from Sprint 2 are done, so the applicant side of the portal is complete.

The system is 45% complete (88 of 195 development hours), up from 25% (46 hours) after Sprint 2. Our timeline planned 104 hours by Oct 31, and we finished 80 of those, so we are about 24 hours behind, down from 35. The total grew from 187 to 195 hours because login and sign-up (8 hours) were added.

Development work

Development work	Estimated (hrs)	Done (hrs)	Status
3.2.3.1 Hosting, Git & CI/CD	6	6	Done in Sprint 1
4.1 Authentication & Security	33	33	Done in Sprint 1; user login and sign-up (8 hrs) added in Sprint 3 (PR #32)
4.2.1 Job posting create, edit & open/close	10	10	Done in Sprint 2 (PR #21)
4.2.2 Public careers page	6	6	Done in Sprint 3 (PR #26)
4.2.3 Application form & resume upload	9	9	Resume upload done in Sprint 2 (PR #25); application form done in Sprint 3 (PR #27)
4.3 AI Engine	24	24	Done in Sprint 3 (PR #28–#31)
Remaining core modules	46	0	Not started
5. Testing & Quality Assurance	24	0	Not started (sprint test matrices done per feature)
6. Deployment & Project Closure	37	0	Not started
Total	**195**	**88**	**45%**

Same method as Sprints 1 and 2: system development only, using the PERT expected hours from Project Timeline v2.

Completed in Sprint 3

Sprint 3 delivered the careers page, the application form, and AI screening from resume text to a fit score shown to staff.

WBS	Task
4.2.2.1	Public careers page and role page with open listings (responsive)
4.2.3.1	Application API and apply page with validation
—	Backend tests for the application API; frontend tests for the shared pieces and the careers and apply pages
—	Test matrix: job postings (create, edit, open/close, manager-only access); careers and apply test matrix results (15 cases)

3.3	AI proof of concept and write-up: prompt design, live test scores, token use, response time, and handling of 503/429 errors
4.3	Resume text extraction service (PDF and Word to plain text)
4.3	System prompt and requirement matching against the job posting's requirements
4.3	Gemini API integration
4.3	Parsing the AI JSON response into a fit score and explanation
4.3	Screening failure handling and retry (timeouts, API errors, malformed JSON, failed extraction)
4.3	Fit score badge and explanation UI
—	Test matrix: AI screening and retries
4.1	User login and sign-up (added feature)
—	Sprint 1 frontend code (login, dashboard, team, auth service) brought in line with the coding guidelines
—	Decision on deleting job postings: [closed instead of deleted / Delete added]
—	Sprint 3 task document, ceremony document, and Notion board updates

All Sprint 3 branches were reviewed and merged into dev (PR #26 to #32). Sprint 3 also cleared the items carried over from Sprint 2: application API tests, the job postings and careers/apply test matrices, the AI proof of concept write-up, the Sprint 1 coding-guideline cleanup, and the decision on deleting job postings.

Added feature: login and sign-up for users

We added login and sign-up for users in Sprint 3. Sprint 1's authentication (4.1) only covered staff accounts; users can now create their own account and log in.

- Sign-up page with validation
- Login and logout for user accounts
- Screening and applications tied to the logged-in user
- Tests for the sign-up and login flows

This was not in the original Sprint 3 plan. Its 8 hours are added to 4.1 Authentication & Security.

Carried over

Nothing carries over to Sprint 4. Every Sprint 3 task, including the careers page and application form from Sprint 2, is done and merged into dev.

Sprint 4 plan (Nov 1–7)

Sprint 4 starts the applicant management side (4.4): profiles, the pipeline board, and stage changes. It falls on the holiday week, so the update is a recorded video instead of an in-class presentation.

WBS	**Task**
4.4.1.1	Applicant profile page with inline PDF resume viewer
4.4.2.1	Pipeline Kanban board with stage columns
4.4.3.1	Drag-and-drop stage changes saved to the API
—	Test matrix: profiles and pipeline moves

—	Recorded video of Sprint 4 updates (replaces in-class update)

Each task stays one branch and one pull request into dev, assigned on day one with a task document.

Retrospective

What went well

- The applicant portal is complete: applicants browse open roles, apply, and upload a resume, with tests and test matrices.
- AI screening works end to end: resume text goes to Gemini with the job's requirements and comes back as a fit score and explanation that staff can see.
- Failed screenings retry instead of crashing, and stop at a set limit.
- A shared fit score JSON format, agreed early, let the UI, retry logic, and tests be built without waiting on the Gemini integration.
- Sprint 3 tasks were assigned on day one with task documents, fixing Sprint 2's late assignment.
- We added user login and sign-up on top of the planned work.

What could be improved

- Sprint 3 carried a large load (portal carry-over plus the AI Engine), which left little time for review before merging.
- AI responses are not always consistent in format, so parsing and retry needed more cases than planned.
- The added login and sign-up feature should go through planning first next time, so its hours are counted in the timeline from the start.

What needs to be done

- Finish the careers page and application form, with tests and test matrices
- Assign the AI Engine (4.3) tasks on day one and complete the AI proof of concept (3.3)
- Merge all Sprint 3 branches into dev
- Release Sprint 3 from dev to main
- Decide how job postings are deleted: [we kept closing postings because applications refer to them / we added Delete to complete the CRUD]
- Bring the Sprint 1 frontend code (login, dashboard, team, auth service) in line with the coding guidelines
- Assign Sprint 4 tasks on Nov 1 with task documents